Team Trust Reset - Study guide

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About this guide

Tools for team leads to rebuild trust and agree how the team works together.

These notes follow the video lecture for this course. Read them before or after watching, and use them to revise before the final quiz.

What you will be able to do

- Run a team charter session

- Name and work through team tensions

- Set up a monthly team health check

What trust looks like in practice

- Trust shows up in small behaviours

- People say what they really think

- Mistakes are shared, not hidden

Welcome to Team Trust Reset. Trust can sound abstract, but in a team it shows up in small, visible behaviours. People say what they really think in meetings, not afterwards in the corridor. Mistakes are shared early, instead of hidden. People ask for help without worrying how it will look. When trust is low, all of these shrink, and the team slows down without anyone quite knowing why. This lecture covers how to recognise the signs, run a team charter session, work through tensions, and keep trust healthy with a monthly check.

Psychological safety

- The belief that you can speak up safely

- It is built by how leaders respond

- It is not the same as being comfortable

Psychological safety is the shared belief that you can speak up, ask a question or admit a mistake without being embarrassed or punished. It is built mostly by how leaders respond. If someone raises a concern and gets a sharp reply, the whole team

notices and stays quiet. If they get thanks, the team notices that too. Psychological safety is not the same as being comfortable. A safe team can still disagree strongly, because people trust that the disagreement is about the work, not about them.

Signs that trust has dropped

- Meetings with little discussion

- Decisions revisited after the meeting

- Blame when something goes wrong

Look for the signs. Meetings where nobody disagrees and then people complain afterwards. Decisions that are agreed in the room and quietly reopened later. A habit of finding who is to blame when something goes wrong, rather than what can be learned. People checking and double checking each other's work. None of these mean the team is bad. They mean that people do not feel safe being open. Spotting the pattern early gives you a chance to address it before it becomes the way the team works.

Writing a team charter

- Agree how you will work together

- Keep it short and in your own words

- Make it visible and review it

A team charter is a short agreement on how you will work together. It covers things like how you give feedback, how you make decisions, how quickly you reply, and what you do when you disagree. Run it as a session where everyone contributes, rather than something the manager writes alone. Keep the language simple and use the team's own words. Then make it visible, on a shared page or at the start of meetings, and review it every few months. A charter that lives in a drawer changes nothing.

Running the session

- Start with what works well already

- Collect ideas individually first

- Agree three to five commitments

To run the charter session, start by asking what already works well, so the conversation begins from strength. Let people write their ideas individually before sharing, so that quieter members are not drowned out. Group the ideas into themes, then agree on three to five commitments that everyone can actually keep. More than that, and nobody remembers them. End by deciding how you will remind each other, and when you will review. The conversation matters as much as the document, because that is where people learn what others expect.

Working through team tensions

- Name the tension without blaming

- Separate the issue from the person

- Agree one small change to try

Every team has tensions. The aim is not to remove them but to work through them. Name the tension in neutral terms, for example, we seem to have different views on how fast to move. Separate the issue from the person, so that it does not become personal. Ask each side what matters most to them. Then agree one small change to try for two weeks, and review it. Small experiments are easier to agree to than large demands, and they build the habit of resolving things instead of avoiding them.

The monthly team health check

- Three questions: trust, clarity, energy

- Anonymous scores and open discussion

- One action each month

A monthly health check keeps trust from drifting. Ask three simple questions. How much do we trust each other to be open. How clear are we on our goals and roles. How is our energy. Collect scores anonymously, then discuss the results together. Do not try to fix everything. Choose one action for the month and write down who owns it. Over time, you will see the scores move, and you will have a record of what worked. Consistency matters more than sophistication, so keep it short and keep it regular.

Your next steps

- Schedule your charter session

- Draft your three health check questions

- Complete the workbook and the final quiz

To finish, book a charter session with your team in the next two weeks. Draft the three questions for your first health check and decide how you will collect the answers. Complete the workbook for this course, which has a charter template and a health check form. Then take the final quiz. When you reach the end of the last lesson you will receive your certificate and a personal review. Trust is rebuilt mostly through small kept promises, so start with one you can keep this week.

Glossary

Psychological safety: The shared belief that you can speak up, ask or admit a mistake without being embarrassed or punished.

Team charter: A short agreement on how the team will work together, made by the team and reviewed regularly.

Team health check: A short regular survey of trust, clarity and energy, followed by one action.

Tension: A difference in views or needs that, if unspoken, affects how the team works.